

Fallback Topic

In case Eurovision data turns out to be blocked or insufficient · Marta Prandin · Session 1, Deliverable 4

Plan B — Spotify Charts cross-country comparison, May 2026

Same scoping logic, completely different data path, no overlap with Eurovision sources.

SMART question

How does music taste differ across five European countries (Spain, France, UK, Germany, Italy) based on each country's Spotify weekly Top-50 charts during May 2026, and which countries listen most similarly to Spain?

Working hypotheses

- H1. Each country's Top-50 contains at least 30% home-language songs (i.e., Spotify charts are not just an English-language monoculture).
- H2. Spain and Italy share more chart entries with each other than either does with Germany or the UK.
- H3. The share of female lead artists in the Top-50 differs by ≥ 10 percentage points between any two countries.

Audience & decision

Primary audience: a music marketer at an indie label deciding which European market to prioritise for a Spanish-language artist's first international push. The headline chart tells them which country is closest to Spain in current taste — i.e., the easiest first export market.

Data sources

- S1 — Spotify Charts: charts.spotify.com publishes weekly Top-50 CSV downloads per country, no auth required. 5 countries $\times$ 4 weeks = 20 CSV files (~10 MB total). Open download. (USE FIRST.)
- S2 — Spotify Web API: free Client Credentials flow, ~250 calls needed for track metadata (artist, release date, popularity, market list). Audio-features endpoint may be deprecated for new apps in 2026 — track-level metadata works without it.
- S3 — MusicBrainz API: free, no auth, 1 req/s rate limit. Used only as a fallback for artist gender/country tags if Spotify metadata is incomplete.

Feasibility checks

- Volume: ~1000 unique tracks total, well under any limit.
- ToS: charts.spotify.com CSVs are intended for journalists/researchers; non-commercial academic use is in scope. [OK]
- robots.txt: charts.spotify.com allows crawling of /charts/* paths. [OK]
- GDPR: track and artist data, no listener-level personal data. [OK]
- Risks: Spotify's audio-features endpoint deprecation (Nov 2024 announcement) — Plan B for Plan B is to skip audio features and stay with chart overlap + language analysis.

Why this is a credible fallback

If I had to switch on the morning of Session 2, I could (1) download all 20 CSVs in 30 minutes, (2) get a basic 'shared songs across countries' table the same afternoon, and (3) re-use the same repo skeleton, requirements.txt, and

notebook structure. The deliverable shape (3 polished charts + 10-min talk + reproducible notebook) does not change — only the data.